STUDIO BROWNE

PROJECT PAGES · PRINT PROOF

October 23, 2026

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Printed from the live desktop layout, scaled to fit 8.5 × 11.
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VALLEJO

PACIFIC HEIGHTS, SF · 2020 · FULL-SERVICE RESIDENTIAL



A shingled Pacific Heights house by Albert L. Farr, the architect of Jack London's Wolf House, opened up to the light and the Bay more than a century on.

Farr spent his boyhood in Yokohama before settling in the Bay Area, where he helped shape the shingled houses of turn-of-the-century San Francisco. This one sits high on the hill with the Bay and the Golden Gate in its windows. We kept his proportions and quieted everything else: pale oak underfoot, soft plaster walls, walnut and stone at the hearth, a butler's pantry in cream millwork. Every floor turns around one open stair, and through it falls the piece the house now revolves around, a cascading pendant that began as a sketch and drops through the stairwell, catching light on its way down. Everything else stays out of its way.

ARCHITECT	Albert L. Farr	ORIGINAL STYLE	Arts & Crafts	VIEWS	Bay & Golden Gate	YEAR	2020	PHOTOGRAPHY	Studio Browne



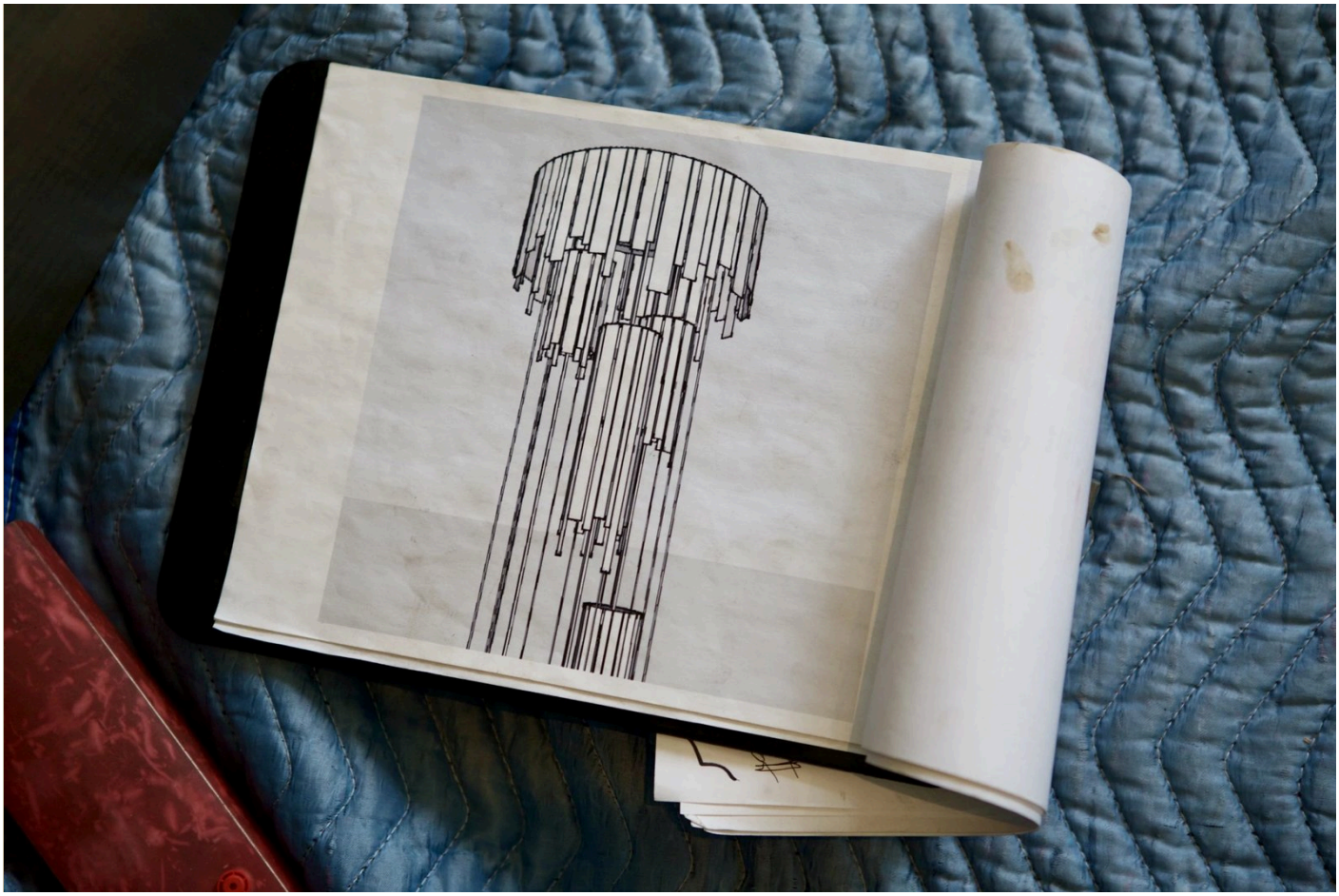


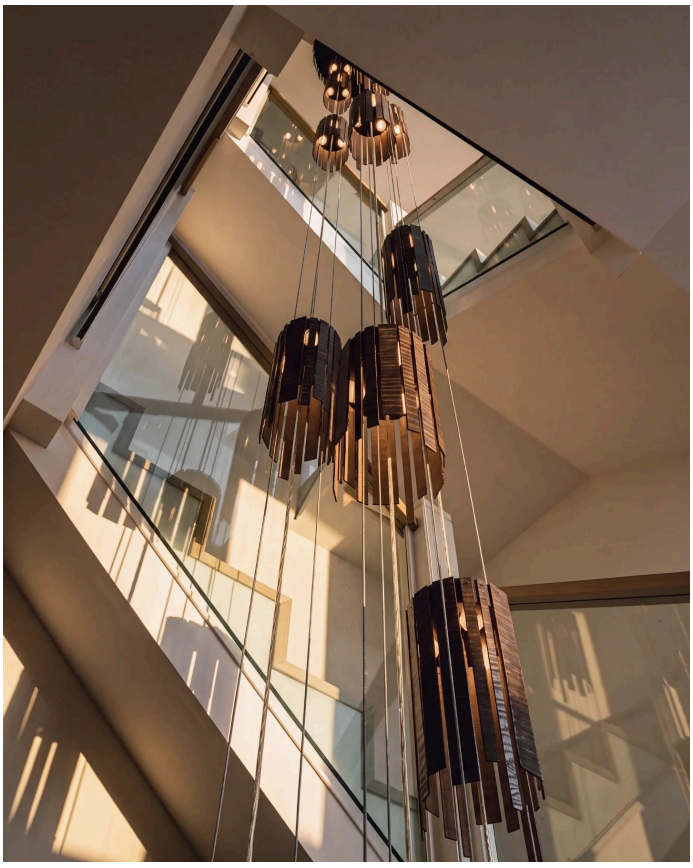
Form
follows light.















A short palette, a long life.

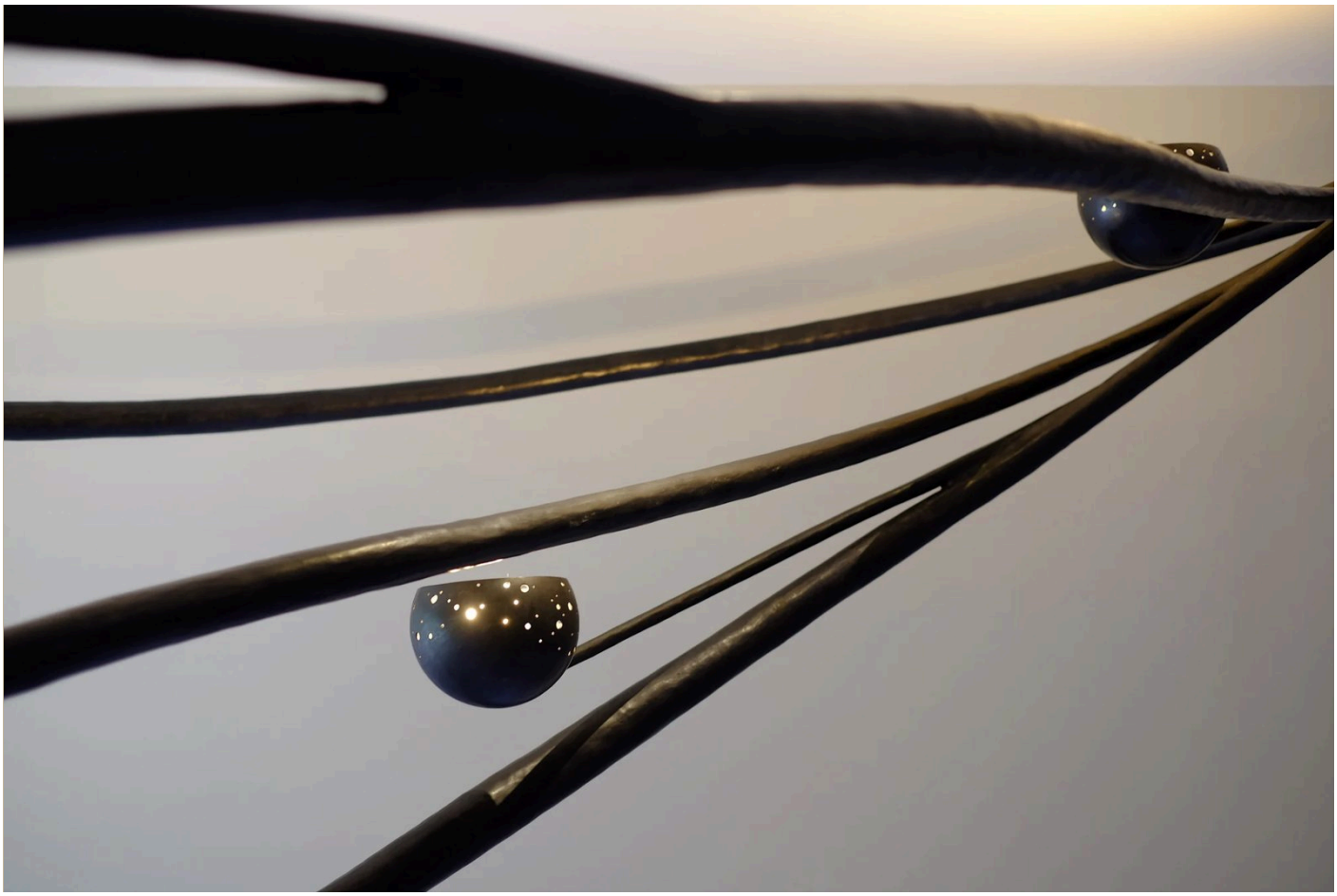






BROADWAY

PACIFIC HEIGHTS, SF · 2019 · FULL-SERVICE RESIDENTIAL

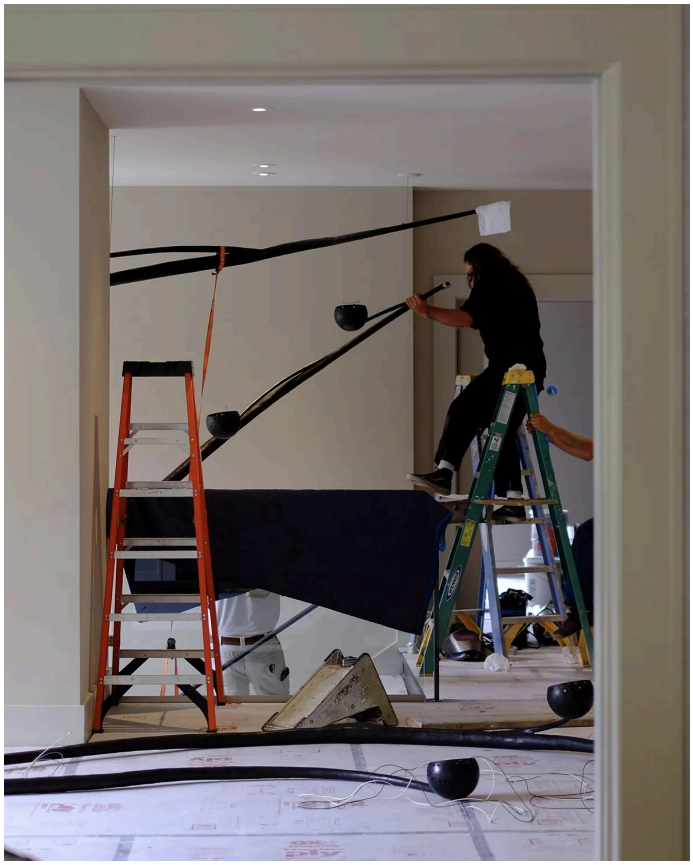


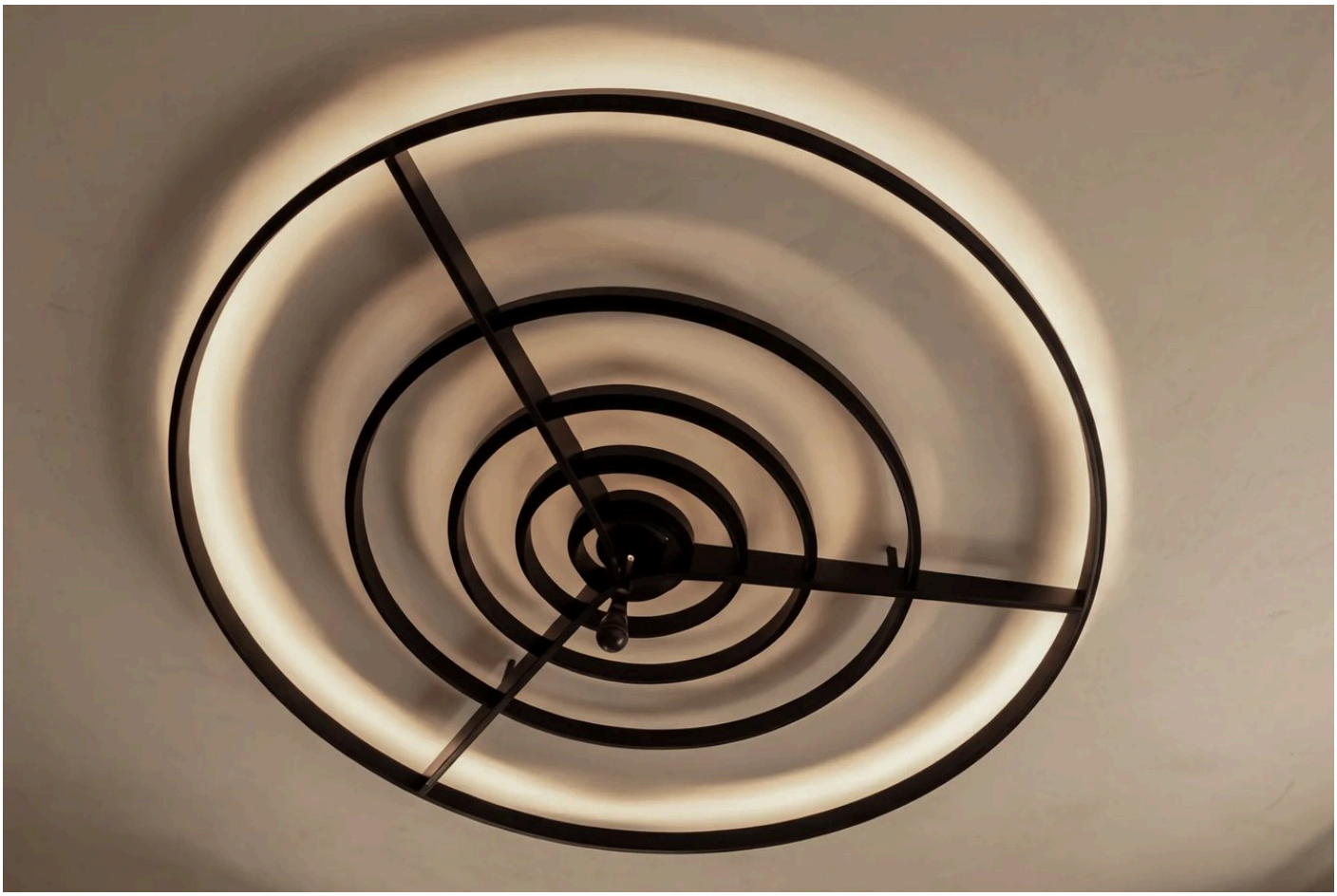
A Pacific Heights house where a few custom pieces carry all the drama, so every room around them can stay quiet.

It begins at the stair, where a ribbon of blackened steel coils down through the stairwell, carrying perforated bowls that scatter pinpoints of light across the plaster. It went up by hand, on ladders, one curve at a time. Upstairs, a tufted leather daybed hangs from the ceiling on slender cables; it was drawn first in ballpoint, then cut and welded in a metal shop before it was lifted into place. Overhead, a spiral of lit rings turns the ceiling into something worth looking up at. Everything else stays soft and pale, with drapery at the windows and a deep rug underfoot, so the made pieces read like sculpture in a gallery.

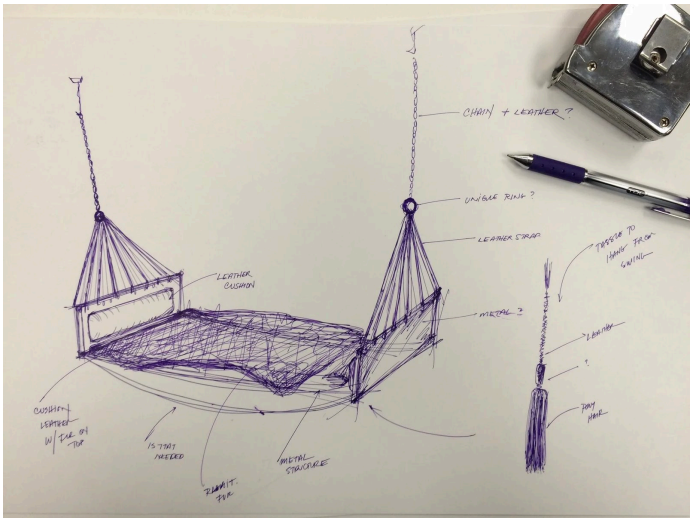
SCOPE	Full-Service	CUSTOM	Stair chandelier, ring fixture, hanging daybed	YEAR	2019	PHOTOGRAPHY	Studio Browne







Lighting, treated as architecture.







One statement piece. Everything else, supporting cast.







TUNED, NOT FILLED

FILBERT

RUSSIAN HILL, SF · 2018 · FULL-SERVICE RESIDENTIAL



A 1914 flat on the slope of Russian Hill, built as the city rose again after the fire, and warmed a century later for a slower, easier way of living.

It sits a block off Polk Street, close enough to hear the city and far enough to close the door on it. The bones were good from the start; what the house needed was more room and less noise, so we turned the unused attic into a bedroom under the roofline and let the rest breathe. Pale walls carry the light from the bay windows deep into each room, and a few strong pieces do the work rather than many: a tufted leather ottoman, a deep cream sofa, reclaimed wood on blackened steel, shagreen nesting tables, capiz and glass-ball lighting that glows rather than glares. And green everywhere, softening the corners and keeping every room alive.

BUILT	1914	BEDROOMS	Three	BATHROOMS	Two	INTERIOR	2,589 SF	STORIES	Two	PHOTOGRAPHY	Studio Browne

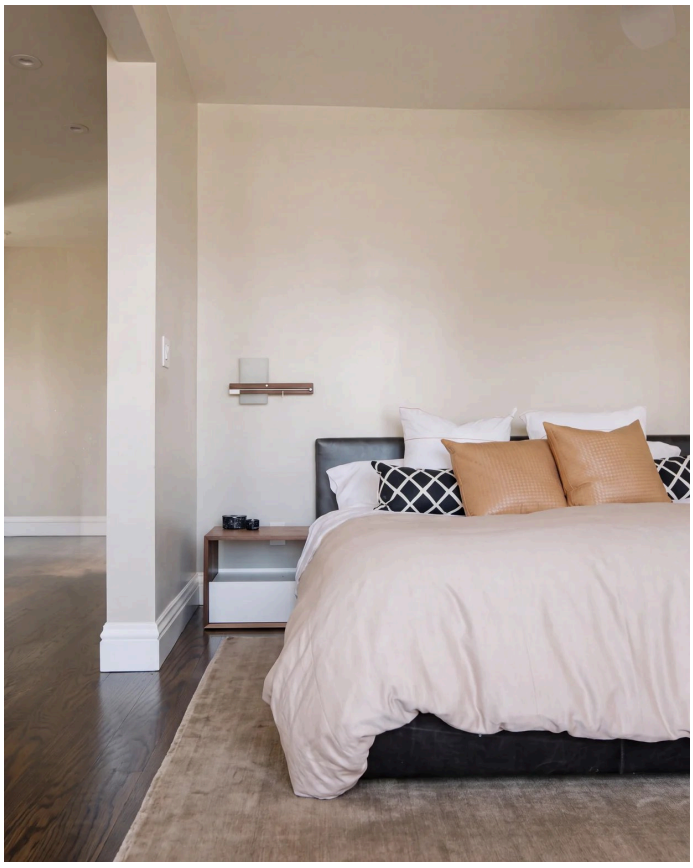




Good bones
deserve a
eight hand.



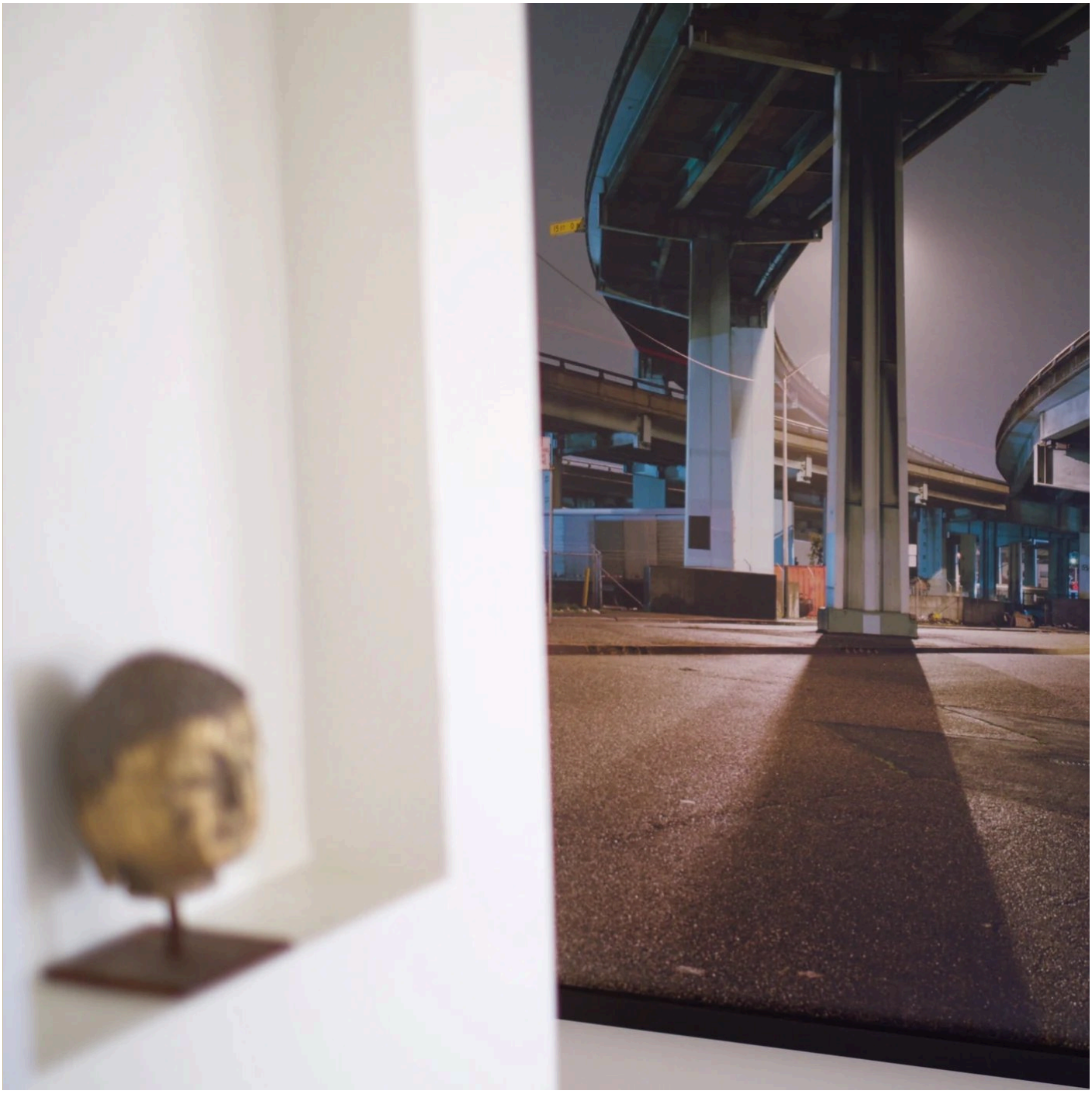

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DEALER'S CHOICE



Negative space is a design decision, too.


THE KINFOLK HOME
STUFF









JACKSON

PACIFIC HEIGHTS, SF · 2018 · INTERIOR DESIGN & PARTIAL REMODEL



Jackson was dreamed up in 1895 by William H. Lillie for Henry Lund, royal consul to Norway and Sweden. Yeah. We know.

A hundred-some years later she was still standing, still mostly herself, and showing every bit of it. The mahogany millwork is all original. So is the stained glass mosaic at the landing, which does most of the talking the second you step from the entry toward the front parlor. The fireplaces and their hand-carved mantels never left either. They just needed a little attention and a lot less varnish.

Our clients were, understandably, nervous about touching any of it. So we didn't call it a renovation. We called it upkeep. Nobody was taking a limb off. We were letting the house breathe, giving each room a job again, and making space for a family that keeps growing.

Downstairs, two original walls came out. Not a move we suggest lightly, but here it let the whole floor read as one room instead of a string of them. The stair stayed exactly as we found it: La Farge glass over the window seat, a Juliet balcony at the top, a copper-leaf ceiling floating over the landing.

The furniture is quiet and textural, some old, some new, none of it trying too hard. What stitches the floors together is the art, collected and found all over the place and hung wherever it made the most sense.

Out back, ferns and Japanese maples hem in a stone terrace and a proper flat lawn. Which, for a family of five and a chocolate lab, is really the whole point.

BUILT	1895	ARCHITECT	William H. Lillie	INTERIOR	6,650 SF	SCOPE	Partial Remodel	YEAR	2018





Lillie got it right the first time.





















Patina, provenance, and a few good quirks.



IN PROGRESS

ROBERTSON

BEVERLY HILLS, CA · 2025 · CONCEPTUAL DESIGN



A Beverly Hills residence, currently in design.

The full project story and photography will follow on completion.

LOCATION	Beverly Hills, CA	SCOPE	Conceptual Design	STATUS	In Progress	YEAR	2025





IN PROGRESS

CABO

SAN JOSÉ DEL CABO, MX · 2027 · RESIDENTIAL



A house in San José del Cabo, currently in design.

The full project story and photography will follow on completion.

LOCATION	Baja California Sur, MX	STATUS	In Progress	YEAR	2027